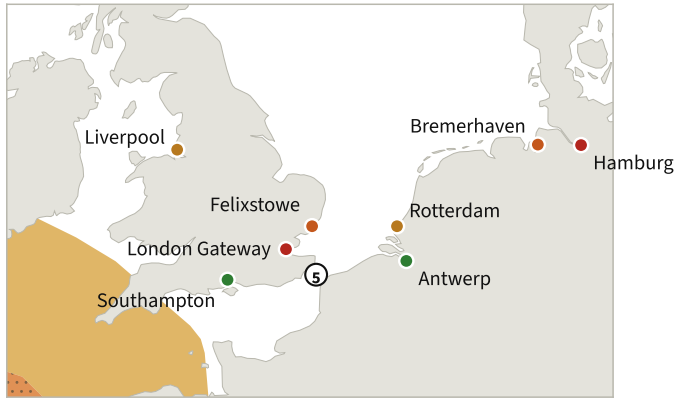
Illustration with synthetic congestion and weather. Not a real forecast.

Port Brief

Issue 12, Sunday 11 October 2026

Felixstowe congested as wind threatens London Gateway on Wednesday

Felixstowe and Bremerhaven are congested, and wind threatens London Gateway on Wednesday. Severe seas in Biscay put Asia and West Africa services 1 to 2 days late. A strike is reported at Hamburg for Monday.

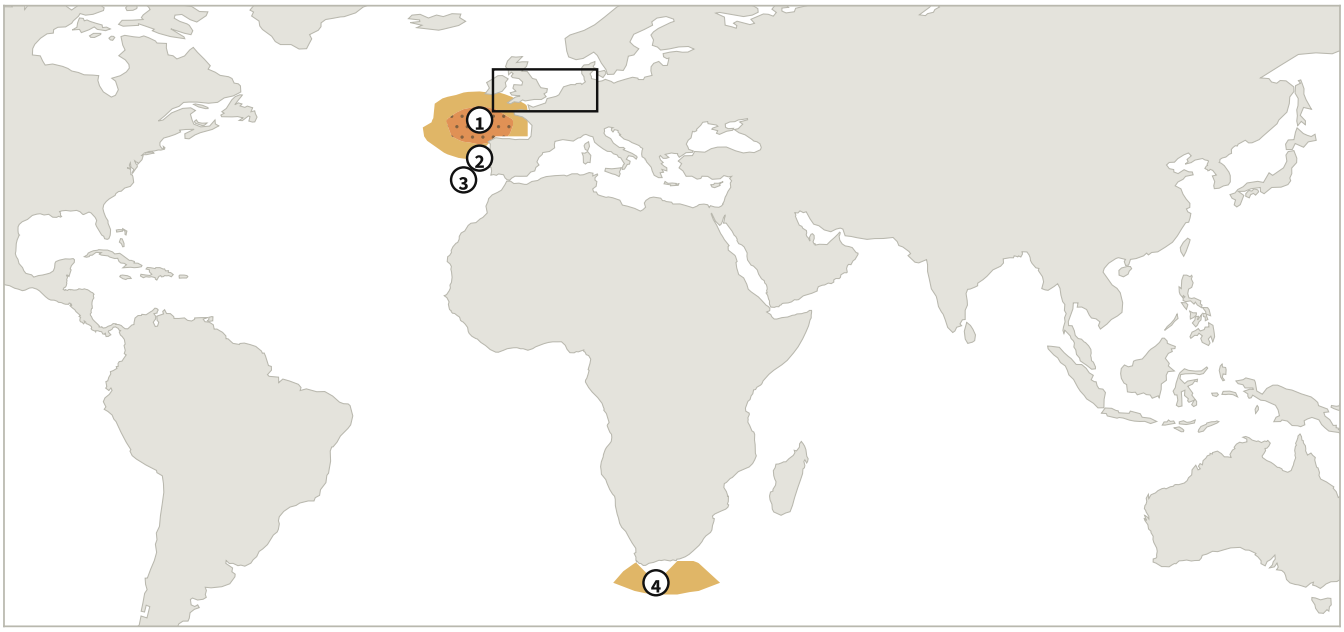


Port health

Port	Berth occupancy vs normal	Crane weather, next 7 days	What to do
United Kingdom			
Felixstowe Congested	84% full, 13 over normal Ships stay 38 h	M T W T F S S	Berths are 13 points over normal. Add 2–3 days to inland plans for the next 2 weeks.
Southampton Running normally	61% full, 1 over normal Ships stay 22 h	M T W T F S S	No delays expected. Book release and delivery now.
London Gateway Disruption likely	66% full, 2 over normal Ships stay 25 h	M T W T F S S	Cranes likely stop Wed 11:00–20:00. Warn your haulier and allow 24–48 hours.
Liverpool Watch	58% full, 3 under normal Ships stay 20 h	M T W T F S S	Gusty on Thursday morning. Avoid tight Thursday cut-offs.
North Europe			
Rotterdam Watch	74% full, 7 over normal Ships stay 31 h	M T W T F S S	Berths are busier than usual. Avoid tight feeder connections.
Antwerp Running normally	63% full, 0 over normal Ships stay 28 h	M T W T F S S	No delays expected. Book release and delivery now.
Bremerhaven Congested	70% full, 4 over normal Ships stay 45 h, longer than usual	M T W T F S S	Ships are staying 36% longer than usual. Add 2–3 days for the next 2 weeks.
Hamburg Disruption likely	68% full, 3 over normal Ships stay 30 h	M T W T F S S	A strike is reported for Monday. Check terminal notices and allow 24–48 hours.

Gauge: bar is berth occupancy, black tick is the port's normal level; orange when 10 points or more above normal. Day squares: gusts near crane limits cranes likely stopped.

Weather on the way in



Rough 4 m+ Severe 6 m+ Extreme 8 m+ Numbers match the route strips and key below.

Route into the UK	Sea areas along the way, origin to Channel	Delay
Asia via the Cape	S China Sea · Malacca · Sri Lanka · Indian Ocean · Cape 4 · Namibia · W Africa · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
Asia via Suez	S China Sea · Malacca · Sri Lanka · Arabian Sea · Aden · Red Sea · Suez · Med · Gibraltar · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
US East Coast and Canada	NW Atlantic · Mid-Atlantic · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
Caribbean and Panama	Panama · Caribbean · Azores · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
Mediterranean	Med · Gibraltar · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
West Africa	G of Guinea · W Africa · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5	**1–2 days**
North Sea feeders	North Sea · German Bight · Dover 5	**Up to 1 day**

Confirm revised ETAs for anything routed past Biscay this week before you book haulage.

No.	Sea area	Severity	When	Peak seas	Delay
1	**Western Approaches**	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	7.3 m	1–2 days
2	**Bay of Biscay**	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	7.0 m	1–2 days
3	**Off Portugal**	Severe	Wed 14 Oct	6.6 m	1–2 days
4	**Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas**	Rough	Wed 14 Oct	5.4 m	Up to 1 day
5	**Dover Strait**	Rough	Wed 14 Oct	2.2 m	Up to 1 day

News and notices

Ports

Other Smart berths: What West African ports can learn from Rotterdam
Port of Rotterdam, Thu 8 Oct, new

Shipping lines

Surcharge Maersk raises U.S. surcharge to USD 215: what it means for Maersk stock
Maersk, Mon 12 Oct, new

Surcharge Maersk raises U.S. inland fuel surcharge to USD 215: stock pre-market at EUR 3,335.50
Maersk, Mon 12 Oct, new

Service change Agility bags EUR 500 mn financing + Damietta welcomes another MSC service
MSC, Sun 11 Oct, new

Service change MSC launches weekly feeder service to Lekki Port via Lomé
MSC, Sun 11 Oct, new

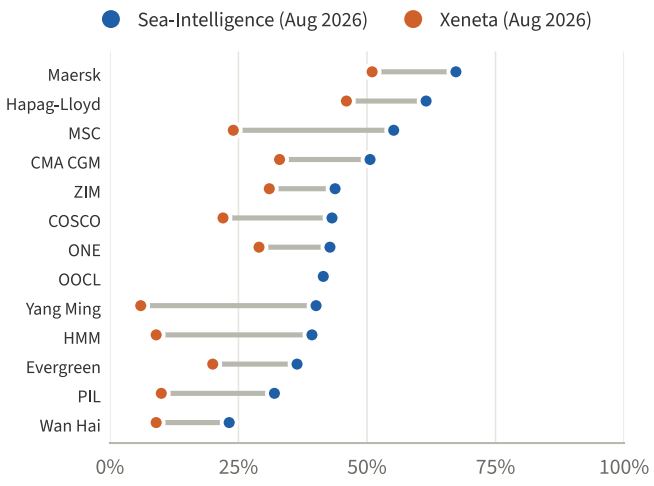
Disruption Hapag-Lloyd suspends bookings to three Philippine ports as container crisis deepens
Hapag-Lloyd, Mon 12 Oct, new

Surcharge Hapag-Lloyd adds Luanda equipment surcharge
Hapag-Lloyd, Sat 10 Oct, new

Disruption CMA CGM: Malaysia Enforces New Cargo Manifest Rules, Raising Risk of Port Delays
CMA CGM, Fri 9 Oct, new

Surcharge Nigerian Importers Face Third CMA CGM Shipping Surcharge in 2026
CMA CGM, Fri 9 Oct, new

Shipping line reliability, Aug 2026



How each is measured

On time in August 2026: Sea-Intelligence 49.9% and Xeneta 29%, which uses a stricter measure.

Share of ships arriving on time. Sea-Intelligence counts arrivals within a day of schedule; Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day, so its figures run lower.

Weather flags come from forecasts. Check with your terminal or carrier before changing plans.

Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Maps use Natural Earth data.

Data this issue: weather complete, sea-state grid complete, tropical storms complete, congestion not connected, schedule reliability complete, notices complete.